Editing & proofreading

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- Editing is a process of writing in which the writer or editor rereads the draft, identifies the errors and corrects it. Editing is necessary to make the content more accurate and relatable. As it has been already stated, it is a crucial stage of the dynamism in writing process.

- Editing = improving grammar, sentence structure, punctuation, word choice and clarity.

Articles

- I bought a book.
- She is an engineer.
- The sun rises in the east.

Capitalization

bangladesh → Bangladesh

english → English

Homonyms:

- Their / There / They’re
- Your / You’re
- To / Too / Two

Sentence Fragments:

- As I was sick.
- As I was sick, I stayed home.

Prepositions:

- interested in
- good at
- depend on

Pronouns :

- Wrong: Me and Rahim went.
- Right: Rahim and I went.
- Pronouns in English follow 3,2,1 order which means Third person, Second person and then comes first person.

Punctuation:

- Commas
- Apostrophes
- Full stops
- Question marks

Run-on Sentences :

Wrong: I was tired I went to bed.

Right: I was tired, so I went to bed.

- 1. **Fragment**: A sentence fragment is an incomplete sentence. It may be missing a subject, a verb, or a complete thought.

- Example 1: **Wrong**: As I was tired.
- **Correct** : As I was tired, I went to be.

.**How to identify: Ask, “Does this group of words express a complete thought?”**

- 2. **Run-on Sentence:** A run-on sentence occurs when two or more complete sentences (independent clauses) are incorrectly joined without proper punctuation or a conjunction.
- **Wrong**: The museum was crowded he had to wait outside.There are two complete ideas: The museum was crowded.He had to wait outside.
- **Corrections**: The museum was crowded. so,he had to wait outside.
- **The museum was crowded .He had to wait outside.**

- **How to identify: Look for two complete sentences joined incorrectly.**

- **3. Inconsistent Verb Tense**: This happens when a writer changes verb tense unnecessarily while talking about the same time period.
- **Wrong:** Yesterday, Sarah went to the library and borrows a book.

Here, since the action happened yesterday, both verbs should normally be past tense.

- **Correct :** Yesterday, Sara went to the library and borrowed a book.

How to identify: Look for a change in tense without a reason.

- **4. Irregular Verb Form:** Irregular verbs do not form their past tense simply by adding -ed.

Wrong: He goed to school yesterday.

Correct: He went to school yesterday.

Wrong: She buyed a new phone.

Correct: She bought a new phone.

- **5. Subject–Verb Agreement :** Subject–verb agreement means that the verb must agree with its subject in number and person.
- **Singular subject → singular verb**:
- **Wrong:**She go to university every day.
- **Correct:** She goes to university every day.
- **Plural subject → plural verb**
- **Wrong:** The students is ready.
- **Correct:** The students are ready.
- **Important trap:**
- **Wrong**: The list of books are on the table.
- **Correct:** The list of books is on the table.
- The subject is list, not books.

- 6. **Missing Comma:** A missing comma occurs when a comma is needed to separate parts of a sentence but has been omitted after an introductory phrase/clause.
- **Wrong:** After finishing the exam Sara went home.
- **Correct**: After finishing the exam,Sara went home.

In a series:

- **Wrong:** She bought books pens notebooks and pencils.
- **Correct**: She bought books, pens,notebooks,and pencils.(You can use comma before ‘and’ or you can choose not to use comma before “And”. Both are correct)

- **7. Missing Quotation Marks :** Quotation marks are used to show someone's exact words.
- **Wrong:** The teacher said, You should submit your assignment tomorrow.
- **Correct:** The teacher said, “You should submit your assignment tomorrow.”
- **Look for direct speech/dialogue. If someone is speaking their exact words, quotation marks are usually required.**

- **8. Missing Article:** Articles are a, an, and the.
- Use a before a singular countable noun beginning with a consonant sound.
- **Wrong:** She bought book. **Correct:** She bought a book.
- Use an before a singular countable noun beginning with a vowel sound.
- **Wrong:** She is a engineer. **Correct:** She is an engineer
- Use the when referring to something specific or already known.
- **Wrong:** I saw a movie yesterday. The movie was excellent.
- **Ask:"Is a singular countable noun missing an article?"**

- **9. Apostrophe Mistake:** An apostrophe is commonly used to show possession or form contractions.
- Singular possession: **Wrong:** This is Rahim book.
- **Correct:** This is Rahim's book.
- Plural possession: **Wrong:** The students books are on the table. **Correct:** The students' books are on the table.
- Contractions**:**
- **Wrong:** I dont know. **Correct :** I don't know.
- **Important distinction**: It's = it is & Its = possession.
- **Wrong:** Its raining.
- **Correct:** It's raining.

- **10**. **Capitalization:** Capitalization means using capital letters where they are grammatically required.
- Beginning of a sentence: **Wrong**: yesterday, I went to school.**Correct**: Yesterday, I went to school.
- Proper nouns: **Wrong:** I live in bangladesh. **Correct:** I live in Bangladesh.
- Languages and nationalities: **Wrong:** She speaks english. **Correct :** She speaks English.
- Days and months: **Wrong:** We have a test on monday. **Correct:** We have a test on Monday.

Wrong: My birthday is in november.

Correct: My birthday is in November.

- **11. Homonym:** Homonyms are words that have the same or similar pronunciation/spelling but different meanings. In editing, students are often asked to distinguish between commonly confused words.
- Their / There / They’re
- **Wrong:** Their going to the library. **Correct :** They're going to the library. Their = possession , there = place/existence & they're = they are
- Your / You’re: **Wrong:** Your very kind..**Correct:**You're very kind.
- Your = possession you're = you are
- To / Too / Two
- **Wrong:** I want too go home. **Correct** : I want to go home.
- To = direction/infinitive
- too = also/excessively
- two = number
- Its / It's its = possession
- it's = it is

- **12**. **Pronoun Error:** A pronoun error occurs when the pronoun does not correctly agree with or refer to the noun it replaces. Subject/object confusion: **Wrong:** Me and Rafi went to the library. **Correct :** Rafi and I went to the library.
- Pronoun agreement **Wrong:** Every student must submit their assignment.
- For traditional formal grammar: **Correct:** Every student must submit his or her assignment.
- However, singular “they” is widely accepted in contemporary English:

- **13. Preposition Error:** A preposition shows a relationship involving place, time, direction, or other relationships.
- Common preposition combinations need to be learned.
- **Wrong:** She is interested on linguistics.
- **Correct:** She is interested in linguistics.
- **Wrong:** It depends of the situation. **Correct:** It depends on the situation.
- **Wrong:** She arrived to the university. **Correct :** She arrived at the university.

- **14. Spelling**: A spelling error occurs when a word is written incorrectly.

- **Wrong:** recive → **Correct:** receive
- **Wrong:** seperate → **Correct :** separate
- **Wrong:** accomodation → **Correct :** accomodation
- **Wrong:** definately → **Correct :** definitely

Classification paragraph

- A classification paragraph is a paragraph in which you divide people, things, ideas, or situations into different groups or categories based on shared characteristics.

- Topic sentence – introduces the subject and the categories.
  Category 1 – explains the first group with examples/details.
  Category 2 – explains the second group with examples/details.
  Category 3 – explains the third group with examples/details.

- Concluding sentence – summarizes the classification.

Types of Students

- Students in a university can generally be classified into three types: the hardworking student, the social student, and the last-minute student. **First, the hardworking student** attends classes regularly, takes careful notes, completes assignments on time, and studies consistently for examinations. For example, this type of student usually reviews the lessons after class, asks questions when something is unclear, and prepares for examinations several days or even weeks in advance. As a result, hardworking students are often well-prepared for tests and can perform better academically. **Second, the social student** enjoys spending time with friends and participating in different university activities. For instance, this student may join clubs, attend university events, and spend time talking with classmates between or after classes. Although social students may sometimes spend less time studying, their active participation can help them develop communication skills, teamwork skills, and strong friendships. **Finally, the last-minute student** usually delays studying and completing assignments until the deadline is very close. For example, such a student may start preparing for an examination only one or two nights before it or begin an assignment just hours before submission. Consequently, this type of student often experiences stress and may not have enough time to understand the material properly. Therefore, although students have different habits and personalities, these three categories are commonly found in university classrooms.

- A **cause-and-effect** paragraph is a paragraph that explains the reasons (causes) why something happens and/or the results (effects) that happen because of it. In other words, it shows the relationship between an event or situation and its causes or consequences.
- **Explains why something happens and/or what happens as a result.**
- **Shows a clear cause-and-effect relationship.**
- **Uses logical reasoning and supporting examples.**
- **Uses signal words such as because, therefore, as a result, consequently.**
- **Organizes ideas in a clear, logical order.**
- **Ends with a concluding statement.**

Causes and Effects of Sleep Deprivation among University Students

- Sleep deprivation is a common problem among university students, and it can be caused by several factors and lead to various negative effects. One major cause is **excessive use of smartphones and social media**. Many students spend hours scrolling through social media or watching videos at night instead of going to bed on time. As a result, they get fewer hours of sleep and feel tired the next morning. Another cause is **academic pressure**. Students often stay awake late at night to complete assignments, prepare presentations, or study for examinations. Consequently, they may not get enough rest and may find it difficult to concentrate in class. Sleep deprivation can also have serious **effects on academic performance**. A student who does not sleep properly may have difficulty remembering information, paying attention to lectures, and completing academic tasks effectively. Moreover, lack of sleep can make students feel **irritable and stressed**, which may negatively affect their relationships with classmates and family members. Therefore, excessive smartphone use and academic pressure are important causes of sleep deprivation, while poor concentration, lower academic performance, and increased stress are some of its major effects.

- Topic sentence:→ Introduces the topic and indicates that the paragraph will discuss causes and effects.
- Cause 1: Smartphone/social media use→ Explanation → Example → Effect
- Cause 2: Academic pressure→ Explanation → Example → Effect
- Effect 1: Poor academic performance→ Explanation → Examples
- Effect 2: Stress and irritability→ Explanation → Consequence
- Concluding sentence:→ Summarizes the main causes and effects.

- **Useful pattern for students:Cause → Why/how it happens → Example → Effect**